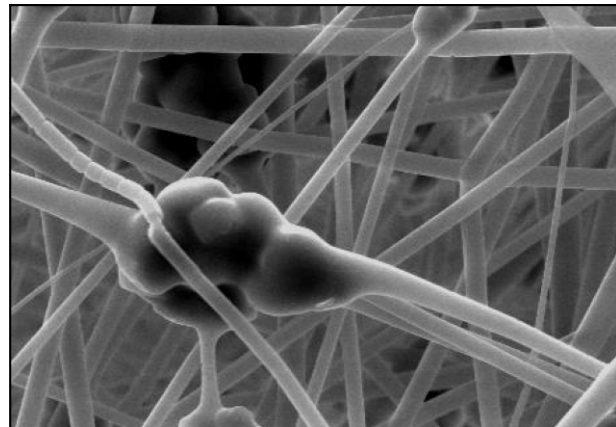


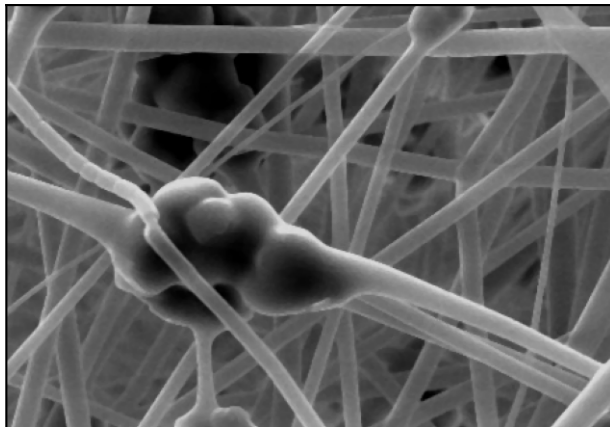
CLAHE gives the widest grey-level separation and the worst usable contrast: it raises the fibre texture as much as the particles

No preprocessing



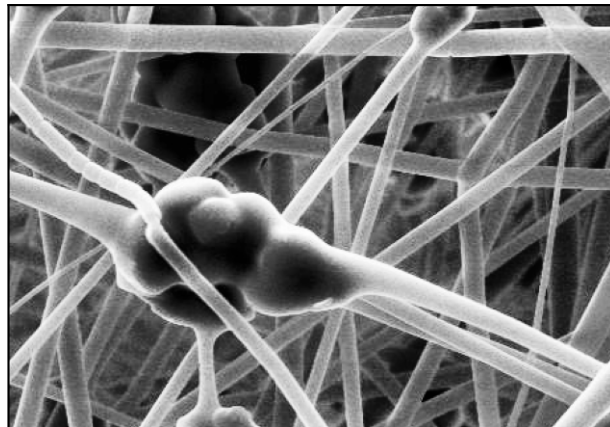
separation 23.6 grey levels  
background s.d. 35.2  $\Delta/\sigma = 0.67$

Median filter,  $3 \times 3$



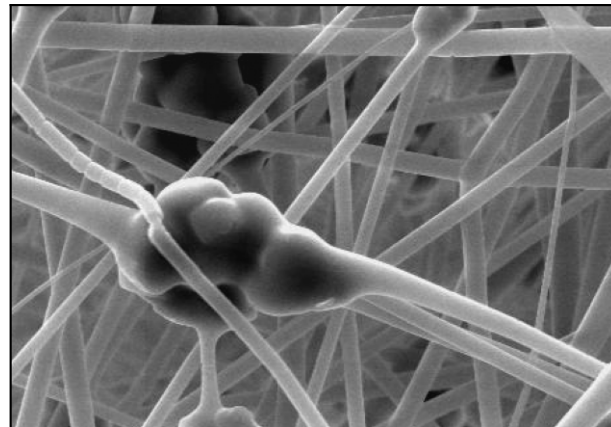
separation 23.6 grey levels  
background s.d. 34.0  $\Delta/\sigma = 0.69$

CLAHE



separation 20.1 grey levels  
background s.d. 60.9  $\Delta/\sigma = 0.33$

Background subtraction



separation 25.6 grey levels  
background s.d. 36.7  $\Delta/\sigma = 0.70$